

What to do?

You will spend no less than twenty hours this semester shadowing an educator as they deliver their lessons (make sure to be actively respectful of their time and observe from a distance) at either the elementary, middle, or high school level. These hours will be split up over the span of several weeks. You can only observe the educator for two hours per day and a maximum of two days per week. These observation periods must be scheduled in advance with the educator and logged with the course instructor immediately following each visit (just shoot me a quick note via email once you're done each day).

During these periods, you will observe the manner in which material is presented, modalities through which material is delivered, how knowledge is assessed, identifying instructional strategies, teacher-student interactions, student-student interactions, student-teacher interactions, and more. Once you have completed your observation hours, you will craft a reflection and analysis paper through which you will discuss your observations, interrelate concepts we have discussed over the course of the semester, and provide reflections on your experience. I encourage you to take active field notes as you conduct your observations, as this will assist you in drafting your reflection paper (7-8 page minimum). It might be helpful to acquire a journal and treat the notes as journal entries (so you have dates/times of observations & what exactly was observed). This will also assist you in meeting one of the requirements of the assignment: providing evidence that the observation hour requirements were in-fact met. These field notes will be taken free-hand, without the assistance of any voice or video recording technology. Once the semester is over, these notes are to be turned in to the instructor and any additional electronic copies are to be deleted.

Each paper is expected to have a minimum of four easily identifiable sections (hint: use section headings): Introduction, Theory, Analysis, and Conclusion.

1. **Introduction:** this section should contain a brief synopsis of the paper and a short introductory explanation of why your selected behavior is sociologically relevant and interesting (although it may seem difficult, take care as you compose this to keep it professional and don't deviate into personal monologue).
2. **Theory:** this section should contain a brief breakdown of the theor(y/ies) you intend to employ in your paper.
3. **Reflection & Analysis:** in this section, you will lay out your sociological thoughts and observations from your immersion exercise. Make sure to utilize all information at your disposal (i.e. content of the media, your own notes, etc.) to assist you with this. Engaging in reflexivity here is actively encouraged.
4. **Conclusion:** in this section you will summarize the main points that you made in the paper. Make sure to reemphasize the sociological relevance of your observations here.

Once you have completed your paper, you will need to write (and personally sign) a "Thank You" letter to the educator for the experience. You will begin your letter by thanking the educator for the time and

effort they put into ensuring you were able to complete your course obligations. Make sure to provide examples of things that you learned and enjoyed during your time observing their class(es) and learning about their position. Make sure to thoroughly proofread your letter to guard against spelling and grammatical errors. You will provide a digital copy of the signed letter to your instructor to complete the assignment.

Graded Elements:

- Evidence of Classroom Observations (i.e. logged notes w/ observation dates)
- Reflection/Analysis Paper Sections (Introduction, Theory, Reflection & Analysis, Conclusion)
- ASA Style (Cover Page, Section Headings, In-Text Citations, Reference Page)
- Length
- Digital Copy of Signed Thank You Letter